IMPORTANT STUFF TO KNOW ABOUT STATIC ELECTRICITY

1. Neutral objects have an equal number of protons (+) and electrons (-). This means they have a net charge of zero making the object neutral

2. Positively charged objects have more protons (+) than electrons (-). Objects become positively charged by giving away electrons

3. Negatively charged objects have more electrons (-) than protons (+). Objects become negatively charged by accepting electrons

4. Objects are neutral unless they are charged by coming into contact with other objects

5. Objects with a lower electron affinity give electrons to objects with a higher electron affinity

6. Polarization is a separation of charge. This occurs when a neutral object is brought near a charged object

7. Grounding means removing extra electrons from a system. You can ground a charged object by putting it in contact with a neutral object because the neutral object will take electrons from the charged object

8. It is the goal of all charged objects to get back to neutral

9. **Only electrons can move between different objects**. Electrons are not stuck inside the nucleus of an atom; they orbit around the nucleus so they are free to move

10. **Protons cannot move between different objects.** Protons can move around within their own system, but they cannot move outside of their system because they are bound inside a nucleus

11. When two objects repel each other, they must have the same charge. There are no neutral objects in repulsion

12. When two objects attract each other you can have two oppositely charged objects or one neutral object and one charged object. A negative object and a positive object will attract one another. A neutral object can also be attracted to a negative object or a positive object because of polarization